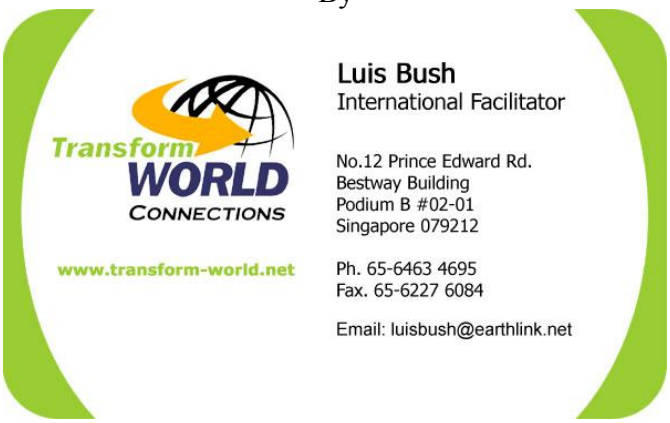
TOWARDS 2010: LESSONS FROM TWENTIETH CENTURY GLOBAL MISSION CONFERENCES

By



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INTRODUCTION

2010 is the Centenary of the Edinburgh 1910 World Missionary Conference. It was agreed at an International Consultation held in June 2005 that its members would form an Interim International Council with responsibility for leading the process from June to December 2005. In the introduction to the paper (see Appendix A) the authors highlight three "important ways" in which Edinburgh 2010 will be different from Edinburgh 1910 as follows:

> 1. Rather than being centred in Edinburgh, a polycentric approach will be taken. Facilitation will be offered by a variety of centres in different parts of the world. In 2010 it is anticipated that significant events will take place not only in Scotland but in many locations around the world.
>
> 2. Whereas 1910 was confined to mainline Protestantism, the participants in 2010 will be drawn from the whole range of Christian traditions and confessions. Particular effort will be made to involve new and indigenous streams of Christian witness from different parts of the world.
>
> 3. Instead of being largely limited to the North Atlantic, there will be an intentional bias to the South, recognising that Christianity's centre of gravity has moved markedly southwards during the past century. The process will aim to be truly worldwide in its scope.

As we move toward Edinburgh 2010 and the prospect of ten or more global events that are relating to Edinburgh 1910 we should pause to reflect and learn from the global mission conferences of the twentieth century. The purpose of this paper is to reflect on the global missions conferences of the 20th century to assess in what way they might be organized so as to advance God's missional purposes in the 21st century.

Mission conferences catalyze world evangelization. This is the record of Church history, which can especially be argued over the last one hundred years. Yet not all global

conferences have had the same impact on world evangelization. The mere fact of holding a global conference in no way guarantees there will be an advance in the global Christian movement. There are certain characteristics of those conferences which advance the gospel. The purpose of this paper is to explore the inherent linkage between global mission conferences of the twentieth century and world evangelization.

Noll develops the idea of turning points in the history of Christianity (Noll 1997:1). Among the approximately thirteen turning points over the 2000 years of Christianity, according to one astute student of history, there were two major conferences in the twentieth century, Edinburgh 1910 and Vatican II.[1] One of the impacts of these and other global conferences was the spread of Christianity to every country on earth. "In the twentieth century, for the first time, there was in the world a universal religion – the Christian religion" (Neil 1986:472).

The importance of global conferences may exceed the personal ministry of leading evangelists. In the last thirty years for example, Billy Graham has become known for his evangelistic crusades. However, what in the long run may prove

> …just as important as his evangelistic ministry is the leadership he has given in bringing Christian evangelical leaders together in new forms of cooperation. The conferences which he and his association have convened may prove to be the most important part of a double legacy. Lausanne must certainly be calculated in that mix (Ford 1986:3).

Billy Graham sought to bring cooperation in his evangelistic crusades. This laid the

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[1]Thirteen so-called turning points identified by Noll include the following: the Church pushed out on its own: the fall of Jerusalem (70) -- Realities of empire: the Council of Nicaea (325) -- Doctrine, politics, and life in the word: the Council of Chalcedon (451) -- The monastic rescue of the church : Benedict's rule (530) -- The culmination of Christendom : the coronation of Charlemagne (800) -- Division between East and West : the Great Schism (1054) -- The beginnings of Protestantism : the Diet of Worms (1521) -- A new Europe : the English Act of Supremacy (1534) -- Catholic reform and worldwide outreach: the founding of the Jesuits (1540) -- The new piety: the conversion of the Wesleys (1738) -- Discontents of the modern West: the French Revolution (1789) -- A faith for all the world: the Edinburgh Missionary Conference (1910) -- Signal of new era for the Roman Catholic Church: Vatican II (1962-1964) (Noll 1997).

groundwork for the significant conferences of Berlin '66 and Lausanne '74. "The results of the Graham crusades could not be ignored. The strength of united witness, in contrast to the weakness of individual, uncoordinated efforts, became increasingly evident" (Howard 1983:2).

HISTORICAL OVERVIEW

The first half of the twentieth century saw serious theological debates and struggle between the *modernists* and the *fundamentalists* (Howard 1983:1).

> This struggle became so intense that it produced divisions not only between these two groups but also internally within the evangelical segment of the Church. Separatistic tendencies, fear of contamination and memories of institutions, seminaries, denominations, and missions that had lost their evangelistic thrust became very prevalent. The result was that cooperation in the mission of the church, on a broad scale, became minimal, if not unknown. Tragically, the divisions and struggles within the Western church spilled over and spread into many parts of the world) (Howard 1983:1).

The impact on world evangelization occurs in different ways as selected groups of God's servants concerned with mission come together from the different streams of Christianity. In the twentieth century more than any other the development of the theology of mission and resulting evangelization results can be traced through the global conferences in the three primary streams of Christianity; the Roman Catholic, the Ecumenical and the Evangelical stream. The Orthodox do not have conferences. They only use documents to present their thinking regarding the missio of the Church. The Roman Catholics rarely have conferences. They typically express their theology of mission in written documents. The most dramatic variance from this pattern was Vatican II from 1962 to 1965 which marked a turning point in Catholic thinking[2]. The Ecumenical

[2]Verkuyl notes that Roman Catholic missiology since Vatican II some Catholic scholars are going the route of emphasizing the coming of God's kingdom in history and describing in fuller detail its features to which *Ad Gentes* referred. "These theologians are developing an ecclesiology which is connected closely with the kingdom and which calls for humans to participate in the events of history, …As he put it, 'The mission of the Church is genuinely apostolic only when her structure and tradition

conferences flowed out of Edinburgh 1910 and punctuated the theology of mission at the time the conference was held.

The Evangelicals used the conference mechanism for advancing world evangelization more effectively than the other major streams of Christianity in the twentieth century. They typically used strong themes. For example, the Lausanne covenant was a new kind of thing which was developed at Lausanne '74. An article in TIME magazine reported following the event of the impact of taking the Christian faith to every person on earth with the following statement:

> Last week, in the lakeshore resort of Lausanne, Switzerland that belief found a formidable forum, possibly the widest ranging meeting of Christians ever held. Brought together largely through the effort of the Reverend Billy Graham, some 2400 Protestant evangelical leaders from 150 countries attended a ten-day international congress on world evangelization that served notice of the vigor of conservative, resolutely biblical, fervently mission-minded Christianity (TIME 1974).

Conferences are linked together in the various Christian traditions as can be traced in Figure 1. The evangelical stream of major conferences held in the twentieth century are in the right hand column, find their roots in the great mission event in New York in 1900 at which 100,000 participants were involved. The ecumenical stream traces its beginnings to the Edinburgh 1910 conference then divides into three smaller streams based on the three councils formed as a result of Edinburgh 1910; International Missionary Council (IMC), the Faith and Order Council and the Life and Work Council. Edinburgh 1910…

> "…led to the establishment of the International Missionary conference, and less directly in 1925 to the Life and Work Conference and in 1927 to the Universal Conference on faith and Order, two organizations that eventually merged in 1948 to create the World Council of Churches. The missionary conference in Edinburgh was therefore, the beginning of the twentieth-century ecumenical movement (Noll 1997:271).

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handed down from the Apostles is geared to communicating the message that in the Kingdom of God lies the world's universal future. As she proclaims this message the Church in every historical situation transcends every boundary and even her own mode of existence'" (Verkuyl 1978:83).

Edinburgh 1910[3] also marked the end of an era. "The Protestant Christian forces of the world would never again assemble in quite such a spirit of high-hearted joy and confidence" (Neill 1986:334).

The Catholic Conferences and documents are shown on the left side of Figure 1. The main conference is Vatican II. The other dates mark the time of the publication of a major document of the Catholic Church

> The Second Vatican Council, which met in four separate sessions from 1962 to 1965, signaled a new era for the Roman Catholic Church… The ferment of Vatican II stimulated a profusion of Catholic special interest groups—Charismatic, socially active, modernist, biblical, conservative, ecumenical, and more (Noll 1997:302-303).

"…the impetus of Vatican II gave birth to the idea of 'mutuality in mission'; that is, all of the church is to be involved in mission and not simply the church located in so-called mission lands" (Costas 1976:65).

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[3]**From Edinburgh flowed… streams of international mission conferences**. **The first has been called the ecumenical stream.** With a growing number of participants from the "younger churches," the International Missionary Council (IMC) sponsored major missionary meetings at Jerusalem (1928); Tambaram/Madras (1938); Whitby, Canada (1947); Willingen, Germany (1952); and Accra, Ghana (1958). … Following the integration in 1961 of the IMC into the World Council of Churches (WCC) as the latter's mission arm, the tradition of mission conferences has continued: Mexico City (1963); Bangkok (1973); Melbourne, Australia (1980); and San Antonio, Texas (1989), with the 1996 conference to be convened in November, in Salvador, Brazil. **The second stream is the succession of evangelical world mission conferences** that lay claim to Edinburgh's evangelical fervor for mission and evangelism. In 1960 the Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA) organized a World Missions Conference, held at Moody Church in Chicago… Six years later, meeting at Wheaton College in Wheaton, Illinois, IFMA and the Evangelical Foreign Missions Association (EFMA) jointly sponsored a world missions congress… Five months later, with support from Billy Graham, … *Christianity Today* sponsored the Berlin Congress on Evangelism (1966). The International Congress on World Evangelization was held in Lausanne, Switzerland, in 1974 then sponsored successor world conferences, of which Pattaya, Thailand (1980), and Lausanne II, Manila (1989), are the most significant. The Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (GCOWE '95),was held in Seoul (1995) (Thomas 1996:148).

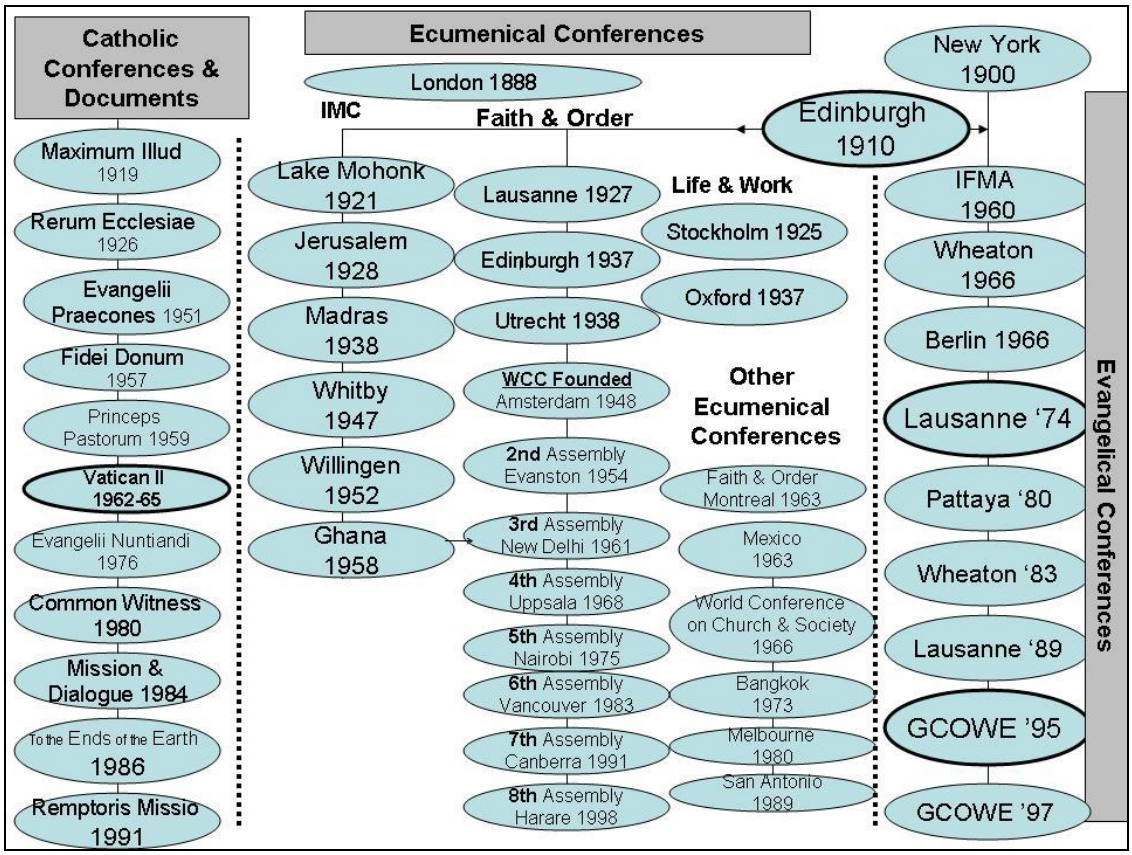


FIGURE 1

OVERVIEW OF CHRISTIAN CONFERENCES IN TWENTIETH CENTURY

There are four events that are marked in Figure 1 with bolder print in that they are interpreted by the author as the most significant in twentieth century Christianity. Of these, Edinburgh 1910, Lausanne '74 and GCOWE '95 will be treated in greater depth reflecting on their impact on world evangelization. The Edinburgh World Missionary Conference in 1910 was considered a major turning point in history. "It also represented the high tide of Western missionary expansion, which had gathered strength through the nineteenth century" (Noll 1997:271).

Within the consideration of which conferences demonstrate with greatest clarity the linkage between global mission conferences and world evangelization, nine will be selected from the evangelical stream and only Edinburgh 1910 from the ecumenical stream. The reason for this is that it is the assessment of this author that these are in fact the ten conferences of the twentieth century which had the greatest positive impact on world evangelization.

The evangelical theology of mission fueled by global conferences beginning in 1960 and inversely, the global conferences catalyzed world evangelization efforts, especially following World War II. Ten conferences in the twentieth century, including Edinburgh 1910 had a lasting impact on world evangelization. These are listed in Figure 2 and 3. Figure 2 shows the name, the description and theme, the sponsorship and the number and number of countries represented.

The contrast in geo-political representation between Edinburgh 1910 at the beginning and GCOWE ’95 and ’97 at the end of the twentieth century reflects the dramatic change of the initiative of mission from the West to the East and from the North to the South. At Edinburgh 1910 there were only eighteen out of 1200 participants or less than two percent from the Two-Thirds World (Noll 1997:272). GCOWE ’95, held in Seoul, and GCOWE ’97, held in South Africa, with two-thirds of the participants and even a higher percentage of the funding and the Congress leadership from the Two-Thirds World. “Three-quarters of Seoul’s financial underwriting and two-thirds of the delegates came from Africa, Asia and Latin America” (Conn 1997:11).

Name	Description/Theme	Sponsorship	Participants
Edinburgh 1910	World Missionary Conference		1,200 participants
IFMA 1960	Congress on World Missions	IFMA	500 Participants 400 under IFMA
Wheaton '66	Congress on the Church's Worldwide Mission	IFMA & EFMA	938 delegates 71 countries
Berlin '66	World Congress on Evangelism Theme: One Race, One Gospel, One Task	Christianity Today	1,200 participants 100 nations
Lausanne '74	International Congress on World Evangelization (ICOWE) Theme: Let the Earth Hear His Voice	Billy Graham +	2,700 participants 150 countries
Pattaya '80	Consultation on World Evangelization (COWE) Theme: How Shall they Hear?	LCWE	
Wheaton '83	The Nature and Mission of the Church in the World Theme: I Will Build my Church	WEF	350 participants 60 countries
Lausanne II Manila '89	Proclaim Christ Until He Comes (ICOWE, 1989) Theme: Calling the Whole Church to Take the Whole Gospel to the Whole World	LCWE	4,300 participants 173 countries
GCOWE '95 Seoul	A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000	AD2000 Movement	4,000 participants 186 countries
GCOWE '97 Pretoria	A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000	AD2000 Movement	4,000 participants 132 countries

FIGURE 2

THEME AND SPONSORSHIP OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES

The faith missions of North America (IFMA) spearheaded the first two events after Edinburgh 1910 with the focus on *missions*. The participants were mainly North American with internationals representing those missionaries or nationals working in the fields of mission. The three conferences held between 1966 and 1980 were energized and funded through the efforts of Billy Graham and his association. Pattaya 1980 through Lausanne II in Manila were sponsored or co-sponsored by LCWE with an increasing number of internationals taking leadership in the conferences. WEF was the primary sponsor of Wheaton '83 and loaned the International Director, David Howard to serve as Congress Director for Pattaya 1980. GCOWE '95 and '97 were sponsored by the AD2000 and Beyond Movement.

Name	Purpose	Legacy
Edinburgh 1910	To seek to achieve the task of world evangelization by integrating & harnessing the evangelical resources of 19th century activities	Intl. Miss. Council (IMC) Faith & Order; Life & Work
IFMA 1960	A purposeful evangelical unity to present the gospel to the lost around the world	Facing the Unfinished Task World Survey
Wheaton '66	Bring into new focus the biblical mandate to evangelize the world	Wheaton Declaration
Berlin '66	• Define & reaffirm Biblical evangelism • Discover the divine strategy of world evangelism • To develop the framework of cooperation	Defined Evangelicalism
Lausanne '74	• Proclaim the Biblical basis of evangelism • Examine our message and methods • Share and strengthen our unity and love in Christ • Identify those who are as yet unreached	• Lausanne Covenant • Lausanne Committee
Pattaya '80	• Seek a fresh vision and power for the task Christ has given • Assess the state of world evangelization • Complete an extended study on theological and strategic issues • Develop specific evangelistic strategies	Occasional papers
Wheaton '83	• Gain Biblical understanding of the nature & mission of the church • Bring integration between various aspects of the church	Letter to the churches
Lausanne II	Motivate and network participants to address the major issues facing the church in its evangelistic intent	Manila Manifesto
GCOWE '95 Seoul	Encourage continued momentum building toward the fulfillment of the goal of a church for every people & the gospel for every person by the year 2000.	GCOWE '95 Declaration
GCOWE '97 Pretoria	Advance the initiatives towards the fulfilment of the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000, with a special emphasis on Africa's involvement	African National Initiatives

FIGURE 3
PURPOSE AND LEGACY OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES

Each of the ten major conferences of the twentieth century had a purpose related to world evangelization. The first and the last events of the century were the most optimistic seeking to achieve or fulfill the task of world evangelization in a unifying vision-driven event using a watchword and by harnessing existing resources.

THREE GLOBAL MISSION CONFERENCES WITH MAJOR IMPACT

Of all the conferences held throughout the twentieth century, there are three that come into focus because of their significance in different ways; Edinburgh 1910, Lausanne '74 and GCOWE '95.

Edinburgh 1910

Edinburgh 1910 was a meeting of the home base of missions yet it was a global conference that surpassed any previous gathering according to historian Stephen Neill.

> …Edinburgh 1910 surpassed all others in the meticulous care with which it had been prepared; in its character as an assembly for careful and scientific though and not merely for the edification of the faithful and the expression of Christian enthusiasm; and in the steps which it took to secure the permanence of Christian co-operation in the future, to which further reference will have to be made in another context… it was an impressive gathering, the like of which had never before been seen in Christian history. (Neil 1997:32).

Communication

Following the conference, a book was written to describe the situation confronting the missionary forces of Christendom *The Decisive Hour of Christian Missions,* published the next year. Speaking in 1975 to students at Cambridge University, John Stott interpreted for his audience the significance of the Edinburgh conference book that incorporated the material and spirit of the event and the immediate damping of the enthusiasm due to two world wars. *The Decisive Hour of Christian Missions*, he says, was "…written before he left Edinburgh and also of course before the Edinburgh euphoria had been shattered four years later by World War I . . ." (Stott 1975:36). There was an overwhelming optimism in the *doability* of the task of world evangelization proceeding from Edinburgh 1910. "In the history of Christianity there has never been such a remarkable conjunction of opportunities and crises on all the principal mission fields and of favoring circumstances and possibilities on the home field" (Mott 1911:1). The content of the book was based upon the information furnished by eight commissions working for eighteen months in preparation for Edinburgh 1910, together with discussions and inputs from the conference itself. The book divides into two primary sections. The first describes the conditions of the non-Christian world. The second presents the requirements of the

present situation, including 1) an adequate home base, 2) an efficient Church on the mission field and 3) what was called the "Superhuman Factor" (Mott 1911:2).

Continuation Committee

Fifty years after Edinburgh, Oldham, its organizing secretary, judged the appointment by the conference of its Continuation Committee (which became the International Missionary Council (IMC) in 1921) to be "the decisive event which made possible the growth of the ecumenical church" (Thomas 1996:147).

Following Edinburgh 1910, Mott was commissioned by its Continuation Committee, to give, as its chairman, the next two years to visit the countries of the world to spread the vision. The plan was carried out with thoroughness and competence.

> This journey of 1912-13 was thus epoch-making for Christianity in that it brought into being for the first time not only the framework of world-wide organized relationship between its Churches in their missionary aspect, but created a living fellowship with its roots in the soil, capable of continuous growth (Mathews 1934:227).

"Mott was an important agent in the formation of some thirty national councils of churches in as many countries" (Hopkins 1981:83).

The International Missionary Council

The Continuation Committee from Edinburgh 1910 transformed into a new group eleven years after the conference. This new group, IMC, met at Jerusalem in 1928 and at Madras in 1938, affirming Mott as its chairman and symbol (Mackie 1965:48). One of the main global structures resulting from Edinburgh 1910, it signaled an alignment of mission agencies for unity out of the new ecumenism that began at Edinburgh 1910. These were drawn together by a primary concern of evangelism and mission, providing the non-Catholic world with its first global structure for international and interconfessional cooperation (Bosch 1991:463).

The IMC gave initial impetus to the ecumenical movement in its quest for unity yet from the beginning showed weaknesses due to its very nature. One of the objectives of the IMC was to "…foster a world-view and to encourage every element of the missionary enterprise to see its task in terms of and related to a total global strategy" (Hogg 1952:362). Yet provincialism and ecclesiastical differences hampered international missionary cooperation efforts. Another obstacle was the doctrinal differences of groups represented (Hogg 1952:363).

The significance of the IMC was that it provided a global structure constituted by a fellowship of mission societies that would catalyze unity for mission. The Edinburgh theme of unity had now found a structural home focused on the mission of the church. It captured the momentum coming out of Edinburgh at which "…virtually a new world mission movement began…"(Mackie 1965:48).

Faith and Order; Life and Work

But there were two other Church-based structures which emerged out of Edinburgh 1910, the *Faith and Order Movement* in 1927 and, less directly connected to Edinburgh 1910, the *Life and Work Movement* which would deal with problems of theology. These two ecclesiastical movements cooperated increasingly, amalgamating their resources until in 1927 the younger churches, who had come to think of the word *mission* in terms of Western aggression and financial domination, voiced their desire for a World Council of Churches which came into being in 1948. In due course, with substantial difficulty, the IMC amalgamated into the World Council at the third assembly in New Delhi 1961 (Neil 1986:411-412).

The ecumenical spirit emerging out of Edinburgh 1910 and embodied in the Continuation Committee, and then the IMC, the *Faith and Order Movement* and the *Life and Work Movement* were the essential elements that allowed for the birth of a World

Council of Churches (WCC). Three operating principles were identified as the keys to its effectiveness: "…convening only officially appointed delegates, maintaining broad denominational inclusiveness, and operating cooperatively on essential tasks while neither requiring theological consensus nor compromising any conviction" (Thomas 1996:147).

Meanwhile, there were growing concerns from more conservative non-Catholic Christians. The Congress constituted a challenge to the *prevailing* philosophy of the WCC (Time 1974).

Lausanne '74

In considering the backdrop to Lausanne '74 as described by Leighton Ford, the long-term chairman of the continuation committee, it is clear that there was concern for the *politization* of the gospel. Fundamentalists and conservative evangelicals were decrying the ecumenical churches for abandoning the Gospel for political involvement.

> … In the 6O's a series of events seemed to be blunting the emphasis on evangelism as presenting Christ so that men would accept him as Savior and Lord, and follow him in his church and their daily lives. The absorption of the International Missionary Council into the World Council of Churches framework in 1961 was supposed to integrate evangelism into the churches, but, to many, it seemed to stifle missions and evangelism. The Geneva Conference on Church and Society in 1966 raised alarm with its call for revolutionary change in social and political structures. … In spite of the valiant effort made by John Stott, David Hubbard and others to keep classical evangelism clearly in focus, the emphasis was nearly extinguished. Humanization seemed to replace evangelization of the goal of mission. Dialogue was to become more important than proclamation. Conversion was more turning to one's fellow man than to God. A number of evangelicals, including myself, left Uppsala disillusioned at the politicized, perhaps even secularized atmosphere.
>
> Then, in 1973, a conference, called *Salvation Today*, was held by the World Council's Commission on World Missions and Evangelism at Bangkok. Again, evangelicals were present and were at least heard, but once more salvation seemed to have been assigned a new content, as mission and evangelism had before. God at work through political "saviors" and secular movements was held by some to be equa1ly

> important, if not more so, than the mission of the church. The line between God's providential work in creation and his saving work in the new creation became very blurred. Calls were being heard for a "moratorium" on missions (Ford 1986:4).

The leading figure in rallying the more conservative non-Catholics was Billy Graham, especially in the preparation and financing of Berlin '66. The influence of Billy Graham was significant also at Lausanne '74 by insisting on two things: the Congress was to deal with evangelism and the people who were invited were to be committed evangelicals (Ford 1986:10). "In his opening address, Billy Graham stated that he would like to see the Congress frame a biblical declaration of evangelism to speak 'with a strong clear voice, one which would challenge the next World Council of Churches Assembly'" (Ford 1986:13).

The thematic development of Lausanne interwove the concepts of world evangelization, biblical clarity, cultural sensitively and spiritual renewal. "World evangelization, the Spirit seemed to say, calls for a church submissive to biblical authority, sensitive to the cultures of the world in which we live, and renewed together by the power of the Holy Spirit" (Ford 1986:11).

A Covenant

The Lausanne Covenant became the most influential legacy of the Lausanne '74 event.

> Without a doubt the most lasting and broadly influential result of the Congress was the Lausanne Covenant. This document was drafted over a long process. Months before the Congress an initial draft was sent to a number of advisers, based on the papers that were being submitted by the major speakers. It was then revised on the basis of their comments, and further revised by a drafting committee at the Congress under the leadership of John Stott. All participants then received what was basically a third draft. Comments, proposed changes and additions were then worked over by the drafting committee (Howard 1983:17).

Despite the influence of the Covenant there was significant tension in its development and beyond. One of the major points of tension was the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility.

> The Covenant, however, was certainly not the final word on the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility. It had left a number of issues unresolved. In what sense is evangelism "primary"? Is the preaching of the Word always and. in every case, the first thing we do for people? The radical discipleship group at Lausanne had repudiated any attempt to "drive a wedge" between evangelism and responsibility; it labeled such attempts as demonic and a clear repudiation, of the distinction made in the Covenant. On the other hand, more conservative critics felt that the Covenant had so broadened the mission of the church as to lead to a dangerous diversion of mission enterprise from the classical emphasis on soul winning first, to be follow~ by discipleship, and then by the social impact of individual Christians (Ford 1986:43).

Subsequent gatherings and an exegesis of the covenant by Stott were efforts to continue to clarify the essentials of the nature of mission and evangelization.

A Continuation Committee

Out of Lausanne '74 came a continuation committee. There were different views presented at the conference for follow-up including the following: handing it over to the World Evangelical Fellowship; set up a permanent organization similar to the World Council of Churches, and those who pleaded that nothing should be done. Two years prior to Lausanne '74, a study of the effectiveness of Edinburgh 1910 led to the conclusion that it was the continuation committee mandated to spread the gospel and work of Edinburgh around the world (Ford 1986:24). It was decided to offer the participants four options by means of a questionnaire sent out several months prior to the Congress. The options were 1) a link with an existing organization, 2) a new definite organization, 3) a continuing committee and 4) a continuing communications link. Over seventy percent favored a Continuation Committee and ninety percent some kind of continuing communication link (Ford 1986:27). The Lausanne Committee for World

Evangelization (LCWE), consisting of 80 volunteer members, was thus established to set policy and give direction to the Lausanne movement (Ford 1985:19).

A Catalyst

The catalytic impact of Lausanne since the 1974 congress has been very significant. Lausanne '74 spawned multiple regionalized events in which Christian leaders met together to pray, reflect and plan for evangelization in their regions. "It is virtually impossible to ascertain all the evangelistic activities that have been generated as a direct result of Lausanne initiatives. Since the Lausanne Congress, the *spirit of Lausanne* has become regionalized on every continent.

In Europe alone, it is estimated that within two years after ICOWE, at least 25 new organizations or missions were started[4]" (Ford 1985:15).

> Christians living in the twentieth century have unique opportunities for world evangelization. Advanced computer and communications technology along with modem methods of transportation make it possible for Christians from around the world to exchange ideas, plan, pray, and work together. While nothing can take the place of unyielding dependence

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[4]In August of 1976, over 1,600 Chinese-speaking representatives from six continents gathered in Hong Kong for the Chinese Congress on World Evangelization (CCOWE).

An All-India Congress on Mission and Evangelization (AICOME) was held in Devlali, India, in January of 1977, with over 400 Christian leaders present.

In November of 1978, 350 Christian leaders from more than 20 Asian countries came to Singapore for the Asian Leadership Conference on Evangelism (ALCOE). The Consultation on World Evangelization (COWE) held in Pattaya, Thailand, in 1980, brought together 650 participants from 87 countries.

In July of 1981, more than 8,000 pastors, evangelists, and church leaders gathered from across the United States for the American Festival of Evangelism, which included addresses by outstanding Christian leaders, and about 200 seminars on evangelism, discipling, and ministry.

In April of 1982, some 200 Latin American evangelicals representing 23 countries gathered in Panama City, Panama, for the Consultation of Evangelicals in Latin America (CONELA) and formed a fraternity representing 98 evangelical denominations.

In September of 1984, more than 600 pastors, evangelists, educators, and other leaders met in Kingston, Jamaica, for the Congress on the Evangelization of the Caribbean (CONECAR 84).

> on the Holy Spirit along with personal commitment and involvement, the developments of this age have made the possibility of world evangelization more realistic for the Christian church.
>
> In some parts of the world, communication just does not happen until people are brought together face-to-face. Fellowship is based on trust, and we have to meet one another to engender trust. Uniting under the umbrella of the *Lausanne Covenant,* tens of thousands of Christians have had the opportunity to pray, plan, and work together for world evangelization (Ford 1985:15).

One of the fruits of the catalytic nature of the Lausanne Movement, the *AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000)*, which became known as *the functional successor of Lausanne*, was birthed, with some difficulty, in connection with the second Lausanne Congress held in Manila in 1989. Half way through the ten-year chartered life of the Movement a mid-decadal event was held in Seoul which transitioned AD2000 from a vision casting mandate to implementation of its vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000.

GCOWE '95

About 4,000 evangelism leaders gathered in South Korea in May 1995 to pursue the ways and means to establish a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000 for the Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 & Beyond (GCOWE '95). An undergirding assumption was the divine superintending of global events, such as the demise of communism and the failure of secular humanism to satisfy the needs of man such that we were moving from an age of unbelief to an age of faith as we approached the year 2000. The explosive growth of the Two-Thirds World church positioned the Church around the world for a major evangelistic thrust in the nineties along with the growing conviction that genuine partnership was the only way to take advantage of the opportunities presented by this last decade of the millennium.

Prayer, reconciliation, partnerships, strategic planning, empowerment, and mobilization for world evangelization were the hallmark outcomes of the 1995 Global Consultation for World Evangelization (GCOWE '95) illustrated in Figure 4. The events of the consultation appeared to move along a continuum as pictured but each portion overlapped at times. Some of these were planned outcomes, but others, such as empowerment and reconciliation, were planned only on the Holy Spirit's agenda. These spiritual initiatives had far reaching effect in impacting world evangelization in the years ahead. Founder of Operation Mobilization, George Verwer, synthesized GCOWE '95 by saying: "I believe that GCOWE is a catalytic atomic bomb" (Verwer 1995:9).

GCOWE '95 was above all, a spiritual event that created a ripple effect among participants from 186 countries including more than 30,000 young people who filled the Olympic Stadium as part of the event. John Amstutz, Assistant to International Director, Foursquare Missions, wrote:

> First and foremost, GCOWE '95 was a spiritually significant event. Seldom has our living Lord been worshipped in so many languages at one time in one place. It was Pentecost revisited and heaven anticipated. Africans, Asians, [Latin Americans], Europeans and North Americans prayed and praised the Lord together. Yes, for many GCOWE '95 was more than an event. It was a life-changing experience (Hardgrove 1995).

Prayer

The two primary spiritual dynamics that led to significant impact in world evangelization were *prayer* and *reconciliation*. The significant role of prayer in relation to mobilizing Christian leaders for world evangelization was observed and noted at GCOWE '95 (Thomas 1996:151). It was highlighted by the schedule of the plenary sessions. Sprinkled throughout the minute-by-minute outline was "praying for the unreached peoples in twos and threes," "Korean-style prayer for every country to have a national initiative focused on the unfinished task," "children praying for the nations," "prayer and

weeping for the cities," "prayer for mobilization," and so on. Prayer was not only planned but spontaneous as time was taken to pray whenever the Spirit led during the meetings. Two or more delegates with hands joined, praying in the hallways, was a common sight.

Intercessory prayer "covering" was also seen as key to progress. Over one hundred prayer intercessors paid their own way to Seoul to pray around the clock for GCOWE '95. The Sunday evening worship service was a highlight for many as the delegates were led in a *Concert of Prayer*. Fifty children intercessors attended GCOWE '95. These had been identified by Esther Ilnisky over a period of many months of international travel, looking for children with an unusual degree of gifting and motivation to pray for the nations of the world. It challenged the hearts of all to see the intense fervor for prayer and world evangelization at such tender ages.

One focus of GCOWE '95 was on *Praying Through the Window II*. This AD2000 prayer initiative sent teams to pray on site in each of one hundred key cities *Gateway Cities* of the 10/40 Window, primarily during October 1995, while registered millions prayed from their own homes and churches around the world.

> Seoul 1995 concentrated a special focus on the 1700 least evangelized cities and called for special prayer and evangelism attention to the gateway cities of the World 10/40 Window. No urban concern of similar strength developed twenty-one years before at the Lausanne Congress on world Evangelism… Seoul, we suggest, symbolized the growing concern of the world church for the city (Conn 1997:10).

Vonette Bright, co-founder of Campus Crusade for Christ and former Chairperson, Lausanne Prayer Committee said: "I have never experienced so much prayer in an international gathering of Christians before" (Hardgrove 1995).

Representing the U.S. delegation, Paul Cedar, Chairman of Mission America, signed a spontaneous document seeking forgiveness and reconciliation with Christian leaders of other nations. It read in part:

> … we acknowledge and confess our sins of omission and commission, the arrogance expressed in undue national pride, the unjust treatment of minority groups within our own nation, the insensitivity to other nations and cultures, the undue dependence on our own plans and technology, our unteachability, the extravagant appropriation of God's resources for our own use, the conspicuous consumption of global resources, the fragmentation of the Body of Christ, and the imposition upon others of our cultural forms as though they comprised the gospel itself. In sincere humility and in the spirit of reconciliation expressed in 2 Corinthians 5, we ask forgiveness for the negative impact upon others of our sinful attitudes and actions and we express our commitment to the unity of the Body of Christ. Will you forgive us (Cedar 1995)?

David Bryant, President, Concerts of Prayer wrote:

> [GCOWE '95] was an absolute miracle. There are no other words to use to describe it. It was awesome to see how God, in the face of tremendous human weakness, perfected His power in bringing the conference together, and then in baptizing us with His vision for the coming years and for each of our lives, our nations, and our coalitions (Hardgrove 1995).

Reconciliation

Prayer prompted reconciliation. The reconciliation between Christian leaders that took place at GCOWE '95 impacted participants deeply, paving the way for working together in the national initiatives and resource networks. To a number of participants, reconciliation between Christian leaders was life and ministry-changing, unleashing a wave of reconciliation among Christian leaders around the world.

> In addition to evangelism, the conference centered on Christian unity, prayer, repentance, reconciliation, renewal and the hope for an outpouring of revival worldwide. Those themes were often exemplified at the general meetings at the Torch Center's Love Hall where delegates linked arms or held hands while singing universally known choruses (Aikman 1995).

The significance of the spiritual dynamic was that it was neither predicted nor orchestrated but a natural outcome of the prayer and bonding which occurred between individuals, ethnic groups, mission agencies, denominations, and countries. It led to a growing conviction that reconciliation among God's people and world evangelization are

inextricably linked. "Many of the leaders recognized that they could not hope to evangelize the world without first being reconciled with each other (Australian Presbyterian Life Today 1995).

It led to the question posed in an article describing the event: *Reconciliation: Is it the Key to Revival and World Evangelization?*

> One of the most powerful forces unleashed at the recent Global Consultation on World Evangelization (GCOWE 95) was the power of reconciliation which broke out like a wildfire, spreading from one meeting to another as various groups forgave each other for the past sins of the people or group they represented. . . (Wood: 1995).

Avery Willis, Southern Baptist Foreign Mission Board, Vice-President of Overseas Operations, in a speech to the GCOWE '95 delegates said:

> We want to ask forgiveness from you for thinking we could do that kind of job [reaching the world by the year 2000] without you. We recognize that it's going to take the whole body of Christ to reach the people of this world. Business as usual will not get the job done.

The reconciliation between leaders paved the way for meaningful interchange and networking across many cultural and ministerial boundaries.

> [T]he global evangelization meetings were at their best when Christians talked face-to-face. This was the case for Christians from countries of the former Soviet Union's Central Asian republics. During the conference, these Central Asian Christians met together for the first time ever, explained a Southern Baptist worker who works with an unreached people group in Central Asia. "What we saw happen in this meeting was phenomenal," he said. The Central Asia meeting brought together Christians from Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikstan, Uzbekistan and Turkmenistan. "We had Kazaks, Kyrgyzs, [sic] Uzbeks, Turkmen and Western expatriates from different churches. There were Russian Baptists, Pentecostals, charismatics—all sitting down at one time.... We had Russian Baptists and Pentecostals—who traditionally haven't even believed each other to be real believers—talking together about their common needs in the work," the Baptist worker said. "The change in this meeting was incredible" (Baptist Press News Service 1995).

As a result of the prayer, repentance and reconciliation the spirit of unity that arose resulted in a major catalytic impact for world evangelization. John Branner, Asia ministries

director for CBI [CBInternational, formerly the Conservative Baptist Foreign Mission Society], said networking was the primary benefit for him.

> I had some great discussions with people from other groups with whom we are planning to partner for work in a couple of restricted access nations," he said. "I suspect that there were many such alliances forged that will have an impact on world evangelization (World PULSE Newsletter 1995).

The impact on world evangelization of GCOWE '95 and the AD2000 Movement is summarized in the 2001 edition of *Operation World*.

> The AD2000 and Beyond Movement launched in 1989 proved to be the most global, focused movement for world evangelization that there ever has been. Its ministry came to an end in January 2001 according to its charter, but the effects will impact the 21st Century. It was a coordinating network of many of the more activist evangelical bodies around the world. (Johnstone and Mandryk 2001:6).

OBSERVATIONS REGARDING GLOBAL MISSION CONFERENCES

Global mission conferences do not occur in isolation. They occur in a specific historical context. Global mission conferences influence other conferences other broader Christian streams. They build ongoing perspective of the mission of the Church which impacts world evangelization. Selected observations are made in this section about global mission conferences based on those factors that most significantly affect the impact on world evangelization.

Historical Context of the Twentieth Century

Global mission conferences do not occur in a vacuum. The twentieth century began as a full flower of prosperity in the North Atlantic perimeter world with a sometimes overt assumption of the superiority of western culture. Optimism turned to

pessimism at World War I. The ensuing ferment of the twentieth century influenced global conferences and their related impact on world evangelization.

> The first half of the twentieth century witnessed tremendous upheavals in the world in general and missions in particular. World War I with its aftermath of the "Roaring Twenties", the Great Depression of the thirties, World War II in the forties and its aftermath of apathy in the fifties, produced far greater changes than any previous fifty years in the history of the world (Howard 1983:1).

The period from 1947 to 1963 was marked by two world-wide events--the end of World War II, which finished with the world being divided up in new ways, and the beginning of independence for the so-called "mission" countries. These two events caused a crisis for the missionary at that time (Zorn 1999:279-290).

Add to these cataclysmic events the more subtle festering socio-political effects of the Industrial Revolution and the twentieth century historical context begins to emerge.

> These surfaced in a secular, even atheistic response which contributed to the century not only the revolutions in Russia and China, but also the Cold war, the Korean Conflict and Vietnam. The "Second World" of Communism, in west and east posed a competitive challenge to the western nations that, in turn, affected the whole world (Hoekstra 1979: 15-16).

Toward the end of the century epochal changes are taking place in the world. The historical context for mission stands in sharp contrast to the beginning of the century.

> …(1) we now live in a pluricentric, rather than Western-dominated world, despite the fact that the Cold War is now over; (2) structures of oppression and exploitation are today being challenged as never before; (3) a profound feeling of ambiguity exists about the value of western technology and development, and the older idea of "progress"; (4) we inhabit a shrinking global village with finite resources, and this calls for growing mutual interdependence; (5) humans are for the first time aware of their capacity to destroy the earth and make it uninhabitable for future generations; (6) societies everywhere now seek their own local cultural identities and reject slavish imitation of Western models; (7) freedom of religion and greater awareness of other faiths force Christians to r4e-evaluate their own earlier attitudes toward other faiths …" (Scherer and Bevans 1994:xi).

It is into this kind of world that the global mission conferences were forged by Christian leaders seeking to engage in world evangelization.

Relational Impact of Conferences

There is a kind of interflow and interaction between conferences in different streams and even within streams. Sometimes, there is the building of mission themes at other times the borrowing of themes. For example, Lesslie Newbigin influenced Vatican II happenings through his book *The Household of God* (Shenk 2001b).

The integration debate of IMC with the WCC, which began about the time of Madras 1938, led to the demise of the IMC. This was an important stimulus to the emergence of the evangelical stream of conferences which began in 1960 and proliferated throughout the remainder of the century. "…as early as 1947… Max Warren had prophesied that it was not 'right beyond the region of possibility that the fundamentalist churches and mission bodies may some time in the next few years try and [sic] constitute an international organisation of their own'" (Yates 1994:193). John R. Mott had expressed "grave reservations about a world body not motivated by missions, and fears that the World Council might swallow the International Missionary Council" (Hopkins 1979:689). Mott's fears were realized in 1961, as IMC did merge with the WCC at the New Delhi Assembly.

Some conferences were convened in a defensive mode to other conferences or streams. "The convening by evangelicals of the two Congresses on World Evangelization at Berlin in 1966 and at Lausanne in 1974 must unfortunately be understood, at least in part, as a loss of confidence in the World Council of Churches" (Stott 1982). .Howard noted that the defensive posture towards the ecumenical movement came out repeatedly. He quotes Eugene Smith, an observer from the World Council of Churches who "…noted that nine of the fifteen major papers carried attacks on the ecumenical movement. He also stated that "…the distrust of the ecumenical movement within this group has to be experienced to be believed'" (Howard 1983:6).

The Lausanne '74 event admittedly sought to impact the next WCC general assembly as stated in the opening remarks of the event by honorary chairman, Billy Graham who stated that he would like to see the Congress frame a biblical declaration of evangelism to speak "…with a strong clear voice, one which would challenge the next World Council of Churches Assembly" (Ford 1986:13).

One of the more surprising concepts borrowed from the ecumenical stream by the evangelical stream is the paradigm used for the Lausanne Movement, *The whole church taking the whole Gospel to the whole world*. This comes directly from paragraph six of the Lausanne Covenant (See Appendix A). "World evangelization requires the whole church to take the whole Gospel to the whole world." At the Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility co-sponsored by the LCWE and WEF in 1982 there was a whole-hearted acceptance of this statement. However, it was borrowed from the ecumenical stream. In fact, it was built into the understanding of the essence of what the WCC called *ecumenical*. "The word ecumenical is properly used to describe everything that related to the whole task of the whole Church to bring the Gospel to the whole world"[5] (Hogg 1957:11). The concept could be traced from earlier reflections in conferences such as the IMC gathering in Madras in 1938 which included among their recommendations the following: "The responsibility for evangelism was the task of the whole Church for the whole world" (Bassham 1979:24). Then at the first assembly of the WCC at Amsterdam in 1948 is "… that the whole Church should set itself to the total task of winning the whole world to Christ" (Bassham 1979:29).

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[5] From the World Council of Churches: Minutes and Reports of the Fourth Meeting of the Central Committee, Rolle, Switzerland, August 4-11, 1951, p 65. (Hogg 1957:11).

Conferences Debate the Nature of Evangelism

Perhaps the most debated issue in the twentieth century conference dialogue across all streams was that of the social implications of the gospel. The debate not only took place between the ecumenical and the evangelical streams of Protestantism but also within the ecumenical and evangelical streams.

Within the ecumenical stream the IMC Jerusalem 1928 conference paid special attention to the relationship between evangelism and social action. An extensive study of social problems was made as it related to missionary work. Issues such as discrimination between human beings were openly debated. "The search for wholeness in mission was evident…" (Bassham 1979:21). At the birth of the WCC in 1948, representatives from the six continents discussing the most pressing issues at hand. "The discussion reflected the growing uncertainty about the whole matter of evangelism" (Fey 1970:178). The emphasis within the ecumenical stream on the social implications of the gospel steadily grew with each passing conference until evangelism is eclipsed completely at the fifth general assembly of the WCC in Nairobi in 1975.

> There was no call to evangelism, no recognition that existing efforts of churches are inadequate to evangelize the multitudes yet unreached. The focus was on participation in struggle against injustice. The vision was of a new *oikumene* where people peoples of different religions and cultures learn to live and work together in a new community where all participate in determining the common good (Hoekstra 1979:126).

Reacting to the ecumenical views, the organizers of Wheaton '66 expressed their deep concern that the WCC had moved from "…direct evangelism toward greater emphasis upon the greater social and economic structures instead of personal regeneration…" (Lindsell 1966:3).

Berlin '66 reaffirmed the primacy of evangelism. But it also addressed the relationship between evangelism and social concern by Carl Henry:

> But the Gospel of Jesus Christ **. . .** upholds the dignity of man by offering a recovery of his squandered destiny through the f forgiveness of sins and a

> new life. The God of the Bible is the God of justice and of justification. The Christian evangelist has a message doubly relevant to the modern scene: he knows that justice is due to all because a just God created mankind in his holy image, and he knows that all men need justification because the Holy Creator sees us as rebellious sinners. The Gospel is good news not simply because it reinforces modern man's lost sense of personal worth and confirms the demand for universal justice on the basis of creation, but also because it offers rebellious men as doomed sinners that justification and redemption without which no man can see God (Howard 1983:9-10).

In his opening remarks Billy Graham indicated that he hoped that: "Lausanne could point out the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility. He expected the Congress to reaffirm that "…our witness must be by both word and deed. You cannot separate the two" (Ford 1986:13). One of the developments of Lausanne '74 was the broadening of the meaning of the term *mission*. This was articulated especially by John R. W. Stott in his paper on "The Biblical Basis of Evangelism." Stott remarked that his position had changed since Berlin '66 in that he now understood the Great Commission to include social as well as evangelistic responsibility[6].

Stott was influenced in his thinking by a group of Latin Americans, led by Orlando Costas, including Rene Padilla and Samuel Escobar, to affirm the conviction that evangelism and social action are inextricably linked at Lausanne '74. They succeeded in

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[6] David Howard develops the changing perspective as articulated by John Stott who was called the theologian-in-residence at Lausanne '74. He stated: "Recently . . . the word 'mission' has come to be used in a wider and more general sense, to include evangelism but not to be identical with it, and I see no reason why we should resist this development. 'Mission' is an activity of God arising out of the very nature of God. The living God of the Bible is a sending God, which is what 'mission' means."
Stott goes on to define mission in terms of service, including, but not limited to evangelism. He ties together the Great Commandment with the Great Commission. "The Great Commission neither explains, nor exhausts, nor supersedes the Great Commandment. What it does is to add to the command of neighbor—love and neighbor—service a new and urgent Christian dimension. If we truly love our neighbor we shall without doubt tell him the Good News of Jesus. But equally if we truly love our neighbor we shall not stop there." Stott later expanded this paper in book form, where he stated his own progression in thinking since BERLIN '66. Referring to previously—held interpretations of the Great Commission as being exclusively related to "preaching, converting, and teaching", he says, "Indeed, I confess that I myself argued this at the World Congress on Evangelism in Berlin in 1966, when attempting to expound the three major versions of the Great Commission. "Today, however, I would express myself differently . . . I now see more clearly that not only the consequences of the commission, but the actual commission itself must be understood to include social as well as evangelistic responsibility, unless we are to be guilty of distorting the words of Jesus."

having this affirmation included in the Lausanne Covenant as Article 5 (Thomas 1998:315).

It was Costas who pioneered the concept of *holistic evangelism*. Behind this work about an evangelism that is Good News for both the sinner and the sufferer is an evangelist who embodied the integrity of mission. His commitment was radical Word and radical deed. Costas serves as a "bridge" theological mission perspective somewhere in between the WCC and LCWE main streams. He rightly concludes that the hermeneutical perspective becomes the hinge point of debate His reflections on the 1980 conferences of Melbourne, sponsored by the WCC and Pattaya, sponsored by the LCWE, illustrate his own bias. In appealing to a primarily social rather than linguistic view of mankind he naturally embraces the need for temporal liberation, the issue of injustice and the prophetic themes of mission over the need for eternal liberation, the issue of spiritual lostness, and the proclamation theme of mission (Costas 1982:154). As a speaker at Wheaton '83 Costas continued to emphasize the importance of a holistic strategy in the context of the emergence of Third-World Missions. He argued that "the complexity of our world, the comprehensive character of the Christian world mission and the diversities of Third World missions, point to the need of a holistic strategy" (Fraser 1983:227).

The debate within the evangelical stream regarding the nature of evangelism came to a head at Pattaya 1980. While the event illustrated the debate between the ecumenical and evangelical stream (See Table 1), it also highlighted the debate within the streams. During the conference a statement of concerns was circulated challenging the conference leadership to the fact that Pattaya 1980 had retreated from the Lausanne position stated in paragraph five of the Covenant that affirmed that "the message of salvation implies also a message of judgment upon every form of alienation, oppression and discrimination and we should not be afraid to denounce evil and injustice wherever they exist".

> We thus have two almost entirely contradictory understandings of evangelism. Some (not all) ecumenicals would define it almost exclusively as Christian sociopolitical involvement; some (not all) evangelicals would define it as calling people to a lifestyle where only personal and individual conduct matters (Bosch 1981:67).

Bosch expresses his view regarding what he calls "…the typical shortcomings in the evangelical understanding of evangelism the section titled *shades of dualism* in a chapter titled an *emaciated gospel*. He presents the view *t*hat the evangelicals truncate the gospel, supporting his argument from the documents produced at major conferences. The linkage of service to witness addressed in the course of the conferences became a point of reference in the ongoing debate.

> Efforts have recently been made to link witness and service more closely. Frequently, however, there has been little success, with the result that service remains a secondary element. Both the Wheaton Declaration (1966) and the Lausanne Covenant (1974) reveal this. The problem is that the solution is usually found in that the social dimension and the believer's involvement in the world are added on to evangelism (Bosch 1980:204).

The consultation on the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility held in Grand Rapids, Michigan, U.S.A., in 1992 was an effort to address the potentially divisive issue raised at Pattaya 1980 within the evangelical stream. The eight major papers and responses included in the book titled In *Word & Deed* reflect that there are still diverse perspectives on the issue. At Grand Rapids, the primacy of evangelism continues to be emphasized yet at the same time, there is new clarification of what that means. In the concluding remarks of the final presentation on the mission of the Church, Choongnahm Cho emphasizes the importance of maintaining the primacy of evangelism since "the root of the problem in our society lies in the selfish sinful hearts of man (Nicholls 1985:234). As chairman for the drafting committee of the influential document ensuing from the consultation Stott clarifies what the primacy of evangelism means.

> Thus, evangelism and social responsibility, while distinct from one another, are integrally related in our proclamation of and obedience to the Gospel. The partnership is, in reality, a marriage… This brings us to the question whether the partnership between evangelism and social

> responsibility is equal or unequal, that is, whether they are of identical importance or whether one takes precedence over the other. .. First, evangelism has a certain priority. We are not referring to an invariable temporal priority, because in some situations a social ministry will take precedence, but to a logical one. … Secondly, evangelism relates to people's eternal destiny, and in bringing them Good News of salvation, Christians are doing what nobody else can do. (Stott 1982).

Wheaton ’83 provided a platform for further clarification of the response to human need among evangelicals. In the book containing the presentations made at the *Consultation on the Church in Response to Human Need* edited by the co-presenters of the topic *Evangelism and Social Responsibility* a year earlier, Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, the final document titled *Transformation* reflects by its very name, the call for societal transformation (Samuel and Sugden 1987:254-265).

The Development of a Theology of Mission

The link between global mission conferences and world evangelization hinges significantly upon the perspective on the theology of mission.

Roger Bassham traces the historical development of mission theology beginning with Edinburgh 1910 to 1975 (Bassham 1979:7). He defines mission theology as “…those theological presuppositions, statements, and principles which critically reflect upon and explicate God’s purpose for the church in relation to the world” (Bassham 1979:7).

James Scherer and Stephen Bevans take up the issue of new directions in mission and evangelization from 1974 to 1991 with a collection of statements on mission from conciliar ecumenical, Roman Catholic, eastern orthodox and evangelical Protestant sources. Their *New Directions 2* reflects the theological foundations of mission from representatives of the same broad group of Christian sources, In so doing they observe that, in exploring the theological foundations of mission, they “insist that those

foundations are not yet firmly in place. Today's missiological world is characterized by continuing change and abrupt transition…" (Scherer and Bevans 1994:xi, xiii).

At Edinburgh 1910 the conference developed a theological vision that propagated the ecumenical movement agenda with its broad concept of mission (Bassham 1979:15). The Tambaram, Madras meeting of 1938 provided continuity to the understanding of mission at Edinburgh 1910. It dealt with the relationship of the Christian message to the non-Christian World. "The question of the uniqueness of Christian was handled decisively. He was God's appointed savior intended for the whole world. There was no other Savior" (Hoekstra 1979:32). The 1947 Whitby meeting called for worldwide evangelism with continuity in the understanding of the meaning of mission from Edinburgh and Madras.

At Whitby, the IMC was commissioned to work with the WCC to conduct a survey of mission theology. This led to a project titled: *The Missionary Obligation of the Church* later modified to *The Calling of the Church to Mission and Unity*. This document contained accepted perspectives on mission within the ecumenical movement but which had not been a articulated with such clarity before (Bassham 1979:31). The primary issue addressed was the tension between the inherent call of the ecclesiastical body, in this case the WCC, to unity as contrasted to the priority call of the mission structure, in this case the IMC to mission. The principles espoused were influential in shaping the future of the ecumenical movement.

> Missionary obligation and the movement towards unity … are "indissolubly connected." Each derives from obedience to God's work in Christ, and each intimately reflects to the other. A united church could give the best and clearest evangelical witness to the world, because mission and unity together comprise the meaning of "ecumenical" (Bassham 1979:32).

In the midst of the debate of the linkage between unity and mission an important development in the theology of mission took place at the Conference at Willingen in 1952 highlighted three important new perspectives of mission the first of which was the Trinitarian basis of mission (Bassham 1979:49). The second new concept was "…the

notion of *missio Dei.*" Missio Dei expressed the "…as God has sent his son to the world, so now he sends the church throughout the whole world to share in his mission" (Bassham 1979:167). The third change in perspective of mission in the ecumenical stream was from an emphasis on the individual to the society in regard to sin, salvation and mission. The preparatory paper by Bengt Sundkler noted the change:

> The missionary motive and outlook have… changed radically in the last decades… in our thinking the corporate category of the large-scale organisms of church has replaced the individualistic outlook of 19th-century pietism and revivalism (Johnston 1978:89).

1961 marks the dividing line between two distinct foci in the theology of mission in the ecumenical movement. The first change in understanding of theology of mission in the ecumenical stream related to the sequential shift in ecumenical mission understanding from *God-Church-World* to *God-World-Church*. Two historical stages are discernible in the development of mission theology in the ecumenical movement since 1948… the first stage from 1948 to 1961, essentially focused on the church as the agent of God's mission in the world. The second, from 1961 to 1975 emphasized the world as the locus for God's *missio* in which the church participates by its witness in word and deed (Bassham 1979:166).

Secondly, the year 1961 affected the impact on world evangelization because that was the year, in New Delhi at the Third General Assembly of the WCC, that the decision became final that IMC would integrate into the WCC as the Division of World Mission.

> The WCC promised that the missionary and evangelistic commitment would now become central to its life and work. The outcome, however, proved otherwise. Integration served at the outset to facilitate the new formulations about mission and later led to actual dismantling of missionary-sending capacity in most member churches. …What a large door would swing on that small hinge (Hoekstra 1979:36)!

Another major change in the theology of mission took place at Uppsala in 1968. Historians noted a transitional break in 1945 in the twentieth century dividing the second half of the century as post-war era, some Christian historians point to a greater sharpness

of discontinuity in the decade of the 1960's (Yates 1994:163). The decade of the 1960's was a time of upheaval in fundamental values and traditions, especially in the West. It was J.C. (Hans) Hoekendijk who connected with the students of the day with the missiologically radical view which departed from the institutional church as primary agent of mission. He pointed "…to the *missio Dei*, God's activity in the world and its structures independently of the church…" This was a very different understanding of the notion of *missio Dei* to what was conceived at Willingen[7] just eight years earlier (Bassham 1979:168). Catch-phrases such a: *the world sets the agenda*, *humanisation*, the church in the *function of apostolate* (the problem of the Church in this framework of Kingdom-Gospel-Witness), and the *search for shalom* (God-given communal well-being) became part of the ecumenical terminology of mission in use at Uppsala (Yates 1994:196-197). Hoekendijk's views infused the stream of changing attitudes which converged on Uppsala and marked a significant radicalizing of the ecumenical concept (Yates 1994:164-165).

The evolution of the ecumenical concept of *mission* led to the reduction of the mission of the Church to social and political activism as Arthur Glasser observed at Uppsala, 1968.

> Following the assembly at Uppsala great efforts were made to involve the WCC and its member churches more completely in the social struggle… Western capitalism and its institutions came under sharper and sharper attack. Injustices created by societal structures could not be adequately dealt with piecemeal. The only solution lay in a worldwide revolution in which the present capitalistic socio-economic-political institutions would be replace. It would be a new world order in which ultimate power rested with the people (Hoekstra 1979:111).

Don McGavran led the attack on the thrust of the proposals by writing an article posing the rhetorical question; "Will Uppsala Betray the Two Billion" (Bassham

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[7] *Ecclesio-centric* thinking starts at madras 1938; by 1952 Hoekendijk is on the attack. He wrote his dissertation on the German mission theory that ultimately was used by some to support the Nazi regimes. Hoekendijk was highly incensed.

1979:79)? Despite efforts to the contrary the evangelical voice was not heard at Uppsala (Yates 1994:198). Though an attempt was made to bring back a balance to Uppsala 1968 by viewing the gospel both in terms of its vertical and horizontal dimensions and implications, by this time there were groups within the evangelical stream seeking to recover what they viewed as the core of the gospel.

At Bangkok in 1973 the term *humanization* became predominant as an interpretation of *the mission* of the Church. The concept evolved into what became known as *New Mission* in Nairobi in 1975.

> By participating n this new Mission, the churches are joining with God in his mission of liberation. They are to work together with others from outside the churches as well as those from other churches in this common liberation struggle (Hoekstra 1979:124).

In a study based on interviews and observations made during his participation in 1975 in the WCC Fifth Assembly in Nairobi, Harvey Hoekstra, himself an active part of the ecumenical stream, noted:

> A definition of mission has emerged that many feel is too horizontal… primarily concerned to work for a better society… Such participation in the social struggle is a worthy objective as long as it does not lead to the eclipse or neglect of the churches' responsibility to win others to faith in Christ (Hoekstra 1979:10).

IFMA '60 marked a beginning of the efforts of evangelicals to seek an identity. IFMA stood for the International Foreign Mission Association of independent North American faith missions. They adopted a theologically conservative stance which placed them outside of the WCC and the ecumenical movement (Bassham 1979:173). The emphasis of mission at IFMA 1960 was obedience to the great Commission. Church growth became a test of mission and Fuller Theological Seminary developed the basic thrusts of the church growth movement which was considered the most "persuasive and extensive evangelical contribution to mission theology" (Bassham 1979:188, 198).

At Wheaton ’66 it was affirmed once again: “…church planting has the priority among all other missionary activities” (Bassham 1979:211). During Wheaton ’66 long-term North American evangelical leader Clyde Taylor explained the change of the emphasis in the development of the divinely appointed task for the Church by the changing of the term *missions* to *mission*.

> Moreover, this “mission” includes all united Protestant bodies functioning in their total impact on world society. This involves the Church in economic, social, legislative, administrative, education of youth, welfare, and religious matters. Hence, it can well be said that the mission of the church is not only to get the “uncommitted” in the Church “committed,” but its business includes every possible impact that the Church can have in and upon society” (Lindsell 1966:143).

Berlin ’66 articulated a theology of mission in an effort to establish the identity and theological perspective of the Congress:

> In contrast to other recent ecumenical conferences, such as the Vatican Council, World Council of Churches, assemblies, and the conferences on Faith and Order, and on Church and Society, [this Congress] assumes both the Reformation principle of the final authority of the Bible and the apostolic emphasis on the evangelization of mankind as the primary mission of the church (Bassham 1979:221).

For the first time since World War I, there entered a sense of optimism at Berlin ’66 in regard to the completion of the task of world evangelism. “Billy Graham has challenged Christendom to think about World Evangelism in terms of 10 years, rather than ‘in our generation.’ This is an attainable goal if Christian leaders are willing to harness the vast potential of Literature Evangelism” (Henry and Mooneyham 1967:514). Berlin 1966 defined evangelicalism as a prioritization of the spiritual transformation of individuals over the political restructuring of society.

Lausanne ’74 took up the task of world evangelization and described this as an agenda which incorporated all of the concerns embraced by the word *Mission* (Bassham 1979:231). Lausanne produced a notable shift in evangelical mission theology. “This occurred through the broadening the focus of the Congress from evangelism to mission—

a move in which Stott played a decisive role" (Bassham 1979:231). "…Stott and others in the evangelical world had moved in their understanding of the Great Commission, which, on Stott's own account, at Berlin in 1966 had been strictly in terms of evangelism" (Yates 1994:208). The Lausanne Covenant brought together the major streams within evangelicalism and even the more theological conservative periphery of the liberalizing ecumenical movement. For all intents and purposes it consolidated a theological and missiological consensus (Yates 1994:203).

Despite the efforts of the so-called radical discipleship group at Lausanne, Bosch discerned the division between evangelism and social concern which he called a *two-mandate approach* and which resurfaced as a fatal dichotomy, as he put it, at Pattaya 1980 (Bosch 1991:405-408). The concern was considered legitimate by the evangelical stream represented by Lausanne, leading to a consultation in Bermuda in 1978 on the Gospel and Culture. At Bermuda '78 there was the acknowledgement for a mission of *holism* and that "no theological statement is culture free" (Yates 1994:209).

Pattaya 1980 accepted the framework of Christian mission as interpreted in the Lausanne Covenant and was convened "To seek a fresh vision and power for the task Christ has given to his church until he comes" (Howard 1983:20).

Two global events held in 1980 reflected the different understanding of mission within Protestantism as shown in Table 1. The ecumenical WCC-sponsored Melbourne event and the evangelical Lausanne-sponsored Pattaya event, though only one month apart, promoted two very different understandings of *mission*.

> But then leaders of the World Council have also been justly critical of many of us evangelicals for our lack of social concern. This polarisation became particularly visible in 1980 when the conference *Your Kingdom Come* (sponsored by the WCC's Commission on World Mission and Evangelism) was held in Melbourne in May, and the following month the consultation How *Shall They Hear?* (sponsored by the Lausanne Committee) took place at Pattaya, Thailand. Neither group had intended that these meetings should be juxtaposed in this way, although perhaps it served to highlight

> the continuing tension. A number of evangelicals attended both conferences and found reasons for hope in both. For a perusal of the documents makes it plain that there was much common ground between them. Nevertheless, the emphasis was different. At Melbourne the necessity of proclamation was clearly recognized, but the cries of the poor, the hungry and the oppressed predominated. At Pattaya also the cries of the needy were heard (one mini-consultation focused on refugees, and another on the urban poor), but the call to proclaim the gospel to the unevangelized predominated (Stott 1982).

After reviewing perspectives on missiology from the various Christian streams in *New Directions 2*, as one of the editors of the collection of theological perspectives on mission, Scherer pursues an agreed upon understanding of what mission is. He establishes the need for a definition of missiology because of the "…current indecision, or a t least a divergence of opinion, about what *mission* fundamentally is" (Scherer and Bevans 1994:175). In his concluding thoughts on the elusive quest of a definition for mission he admits that it remains obscure: "Missiology, reflecting the status of mission itself, is in a state of flux and ferment. No single definition of 'what missiology is' will satisfy all stripes of missiologist in the absence of prior agreement on 'what mission is'" (Scherer and Bevans 1994:175). The quest for understanding *mission* and *missiology* continues.

One group that has responded to the challenge of the search for the meaning of mission is the American Society of Missiology which has come up with a definition helpful for its clarity and brevity. "By mission is meant the effort to effect passage over the boundary between faith in Jesus Christ and its absence" (Shenk 1999:xi). A helpful concept in the pursuit of a meaning for mission is the realization that "Mission is synonymous with movement. It stands for purposeful going and doing. Mission implies challenge to the status quo and invites change" (Shenk 1999:1). In pursuing the path for the future of the conceptualization of *mission* as movement Wilbert Shenk explores the changing frontiers of *mission*. Several observations from his reflection help to set the stage for the next phase of the *mission* enterprise.

> 1. The modern missionary movement …has ended, and a new epoch in Christian mission is unfolding. 2. Christian faith is inherently expansionist: this expansionist impulse is linked to the goal of history. 3. Renewal of faith will be linked to the recovery of a vision of Jesus Christ as God incarnate who became savior and lord; genuine renewal will issue in fresh missionary witness. 3. Faithful mission is always in vital relationship with the sociopolitical realm. 5. The church of the future will be a minority church in many parts of the world. 6. In every age the church must struggle to remain open to the fullness of the gospel. 7. The Word is the singular seminal force. 8. the greatest integrity and vitality of faith today appears to be found in those churches that have suffered and known martyrdom firsthand (Shenk 1999:186-190).

WHAT KIND OF IMPACT DO CONFERENCES HAVE?

In his 1996 article titled *World Mission Conferences: What Impact do they have* Norman Thomas identifies eight kinds of impact of world conferences related to mission and evangelism as follows: uniting in prayer, broadening *koinonia*, networking for mission, training for ecumenical leadership, inspiring for world evangelization, transforming mission theology, deepening analysis of mission contexts, and envisioning new wineskins (Thomas 1996:146).

Kinds of Impact of World Conferences

Charles Forman presents a reaction to the article by Thomas observing that the impact of conferences on world evangelization tends to fall into two broad categories (Forman 1996:155).

1. Impact on participants within the conference
    - In fostering united prayer
    - Networking for mission
    - Intensifying Fellowship
    - Training for ecumenical leadership

TABLE 1
COMPARISON OF THE ECUMENCIAL AND EVANGELICAL UNDERSTANDING OF MISSION
(Adapted from Bosch 1981:65-66)

Melbourne	Pattaya
1. Showed a preference for "Jesus language" of the Gospels	1. Showed a preference of the language of Paul's epistles.
2. Began with "human's disorder"	2. Began with "God's design"
3. Stressed unity (at the expense of truth?)	3. Stressed truth (at the expense of unity?)
4. Believe that God reveals himself also through contemporary experience	4. Believe that God reveals himself only through Jesus Christ (and in scripture/the church)
5. Emphasized the deed (orthopraxis)	5. Emphasized the word (orthodoxy)
6. Regarded social involvement as part and parcel (or all?) of the Christian mission	6. Regarded social involvement as separate from mission, or as a result of conversion
7. Judged societal ethics to be of prime importance. Viewed sin as having a corporate dimension	7. Judged personal ethics to be of prime importance. Viewed sin as exclusively
8. Tended to equate mission with humanization or social change	8. Tended to equate mission with a call to conversion or church planting
9. Viewed proclamation as rendering support to fellowship and service	9. Viewed proclamation as primary; it gives birth to fellowship and service
10. Emphasized liberation	10. Emphasized justification and redemption
11. Heard the cry of the poor and the oppressed	11. Heard the cry of the lost
12. Considered humans from the perspective of creation	12. Considered humans from the perspective of the Fall
13. Judged humanity positively	13. Judged humanity negatively
14. Denied the existence of clear boundaries between the church and the world	14. Affirmed the existence of clear boundaries between the church and the world
15. Regarded the world as the main arena of God's activity	15 Regarded the church as the main arena of God's activity
16. Underscored the church's credibility	16. Underscored the church's opportunities
17. Divided the world into rich and poor, oppressor and oppressed	17. Divided the world into "people groups"
18. Revealed a proclivity towards socialism	18. Revealed a proclivity towards capitalism
19. Highlighted Jesus' human nature	19. Highlighted Jesus' divine nature
20. Focused attention on the universality of Christ	20. Focused attention on the uniqueness of Christ

2. Impact for what it does without the conference
   - Inspiring for world evangelization
   - Transforming mission theology
   - Deepening analysis of mission contexts
   - Envisioning new wineskins.

The effect on participants during a conference may have a major impact on world evangelization outside and some of these items may be more important than others in terms of the catalytic effect that they have. In either case the assessment is somewhat subjective. Regardless, I agree with the categories that Thomas has identified and Forman organized. The category that stands out from all the others in my view is transforming mission theology. In reviewing the one hundred years of global conferences and the four major Christian streams of Roman Catholic, Orthodox, Ecumenical and Evangelical the impact of world evangelization as a result of the evangelical conferences both on the home mission sending and supporting constituency and the field greatly exceeds that of the other three streams.

Assessing Global Impact of Conferences on World Evangelization

In assessing the impact on world evangelization the three most important of the four categories in the author's perspective that are identified by Thomas and categorized by Forman as those that have an impact for what the conference does outside of the participants themselves is considered.

Inspiring for World Evangelization

Those conferences which presented a clear clarion call were most effective in inspiring world evangelization "The evangelization of nations, the Christianizing of empires and kingdoms, is the object before us," Edinburgh declared. "The work has to be done now. It is urgent and must be pressed forward at once" (Thomas 1996:153). The watchword used to rally students for mission in the Student Volunteer Movement was

picked up at Wheaton ’66 and Berlin ’66. "Our goal is nothing short of the evangelization of the human race in this generation, by every means God has given to the mind and will of men," the congress declared in its closing statement (Mooneyham and Henry 1966).

Lausanne ’74 declared *Let the Earth Hear His Voice* and addressed the question *How Shall They Hear?* at Pattaya 1980, and *Proclaim Christ Till He Comes* at Lausanne II in Manila 1989. However, LCWE borrowed from the ecumenical stream of conference-reflection and became best known for their call for *the whole Church to take the Whole Gospel to the Whole World*. GCOWE ’95 and ’97 called for *A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000*.

Transforming Mission Theology

Throughout the twentieth century the core theology issue was related to the inspiration, infallibility and interpretation of the Scriptures. The first sustained applause in the opening address at Lausanne ’74 given by Billy Graham revealed the importance to the participants when he said: “We are committed to the authority of Scripture; we hold the entire Bible is the infallible word of God” (Ford 1986:11). In presenting the address on *mission* he gave at Lausanne to Cambridge university students in 1975, in which he reflects on the five key words of *mission*, Stott acknowledges the core question of a *biblical hermeneutic* in the opening remarks: “Perhaps the greatest need in current ecumenical debate is to find an agreed biblical hermeneutic, for without this a broader consensus on the meaning and obligation of ‘mission’ is unlikely ever to be reached (Stott 1975:10).

Deepening Analysis of Mission Contexts

In responding to Thomas’ article on the impact of world conferences Forman concludes that Edinburgh 1910 and Lausanne 1974 made the greatest contribution in the deepening analysis of mission contexts. It was not only the analysis carried out in the

preparations for Edinburgh by six commissions, but in the follow-up of the conference that the analysis took place in more than thirty regional and national conferences around he world.

> They proceeded to analyze the mission coverage in each nation and arrange for a more complete and rationalized distribution of mission work. The World Dominion Surveys of the 1930s were an outgrowth of this process, with some twenty volumes published on various countries and areas (Forman 1996:157).

The Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization Strategy Working Group, investigated the unreached peoples of the world and held conferences on the unreached peoples.

The most detailed development, assessment, publication and distribution of the unreached peoples was done in relation to GCOWE ’95 and ’97 by the AD2000 & Beyond Movement. Following GCOWE ’97 in South Africa, a Christian leader listed the *Unique Contributions of the AD2000 Movement to World Evangelization* which included the following items:

- Has empowered an unprecedented global awareness of and commitment to completion of the Great Commission.
- Has produced an unprecedented, global Third World, Non-Western awareness of, commitment to, and involvement in leadership for fulfillment of the Great Commission.
- Has provided an unprecedented global platform on which mission/church leadership from East/West and North/South have been able to meet for action plans related to fulfillment of the Great Commission.
- Has provided an unprecedented global awareness of the need for national and people-groups specific strategies for evangelism in contrast to the traditional ad hoc approaches (Butler 1997).

CONCLUSION: THE LESSONS LEARNED

A review of selected conferences in the twentieth century provide some important lessons to be learned which are listed here. Conferences from the evangelical world were more successful in it than the Catholic or Ecumenical. Several facts emerged in conversation with Wilbert Shenk.

> Evangelicals kept up the momentum when WCC and the Catholics have subsided in the last fifteen years. The evangelicals have maintained the confidence of the lay people and managed to raise the funds for the events. Evangelicals have used conferences to create stronger unity" (Shenk 2001a).

There are several reasons that global conferences have a greater impact on world evangelization among which are the following:

1. Planners of every international mission conference face a tension in the purpose. "Shall the primary purpose be to inspire and educate for mission? Or shall the purpose be to study thoroughly and reach a new consensus on vital questions of mission thought and action?" The genius of Edinburgh 1910 was that it achieved both goals. The conference was the climax of an essential process of reflection (Thomas 1996:153).

2. A conference is more effective if it is part of a process rather than an end in itself. "The Edinburgh Continuation Committee, through follow-up conferences, stimulated the formation of missionary councils on national and regional bases, which became building blocks of the future ecumenical movement" (Thomas 1996:153).

3. A conference does not stand in isolation. Every mission conference is apart of historic line of events convened for the purposes of enhancing mission. "Any consideration of the future of the missionary movement must take into the factors that originally produced it (Walls 1996:258). Yet there are times to assess when a movement has run its

course. “The missionary movement is now in its old age. It is not a useless and decrepit old age. There are situation where it provides the most effective…means of making any witness to Christ…But the conditions that produced a movement have changed…(Walls 1996:261).

4. A conference is more effective if it follows up with a continuation committee that carries the conference spirit and essentials around the world. This occurred in relation to Edinburgh 1910, the Lausanne conferences and the GCOWE events.

5. A conference which makes a catalytic impact on world evangelization understands and is able to articulate the significance of the historical context in which it is taking place. For example the IFMA ’60 conference, at the close of the Congress a world survey overview appealed to the fact that the world’s population had increased seventy-five percent in the preceding fifty years and that most of increase had been among the underprivileged people (Percy1961:8). It also emphasized the need of the hour.

> You and I live in a world of turmoil. It is a day of drastic upheaval and unparalleled change. The fifty years which have passed since the Edinburgh Conference in 1910 have been the most revolutionary in man’s history. The technical advance in man’s ingenuity has brought the most remote nations to our doorstep… The speeding up of travel and communications ahs telescoped centuries into decades, years into months and days into hours (Percy 1961:7).

6. A conference needs to address the issue of appropriate structures for mission. Each generation of Christian leaders are to keep an eye on what God is doing in and through the Church, be prepared to reinvent their structures and find the appropriate *wineskin* to support those divine initiatives. In his chapter *on Missionary Societies and the Fortunate Subversion of the Church*, Andrew Walls observes the values of different kinds of structures. The voluntary association offers “…its instrumental character, its relatively recent origin, and its special structure…individuals, churches and congregations freely act together for an object of common interest. It is essentially a pragmatic approach, the

design of an instrument for a specific purpose" (Walls 1996:242). On the other hand church structures "…could only do what they had always done; a new concept needed a new instrument" (Walls 1996:243).

7. A conference needs to watch its mission theology closely. We may well take heed to some of the last written words of Paul to one of his mentorees when he wrote: "Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers" (1 Ti. 4:16).

What the role of global mission conferences will be in the twenty-first century is yet to be seen.

> Is a new model of international mission conferences possible in the twenty-first century? Will it address needs both for inspiration and collective action--both for global unity and local autonomy? In this information age, new possibilities are emerging. Electronic networking and the sharing of information through the Internet make possible not merely rapid transmission of information before international conferences but also wide and deep discussion of issues before, during, and after them (Thomas 1996:154).

My own conclusion is that global mission conferences have had and always will have an impact on world evangelization. The anticipation of at least ten global conferences in 2010, most of which claim to successors or even "the successor" of Edinburgh 1910, accentuates the conclusion of the sponsors of these events that global mission conferences have enough impact on world evangelization to justify the personal, financial and administrative resources needed to organize them.[8] Edinburgh 1910 has become a hub from which an international round of initiatives and events seek direction

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[8] Conferences under discussion in September 2005 include the following: 1) the World Council of Churches, 2). The Lutheran World Federation, 3). The Lausanne Committee, 4). The Scottish Council of Churches in Edinburgh, 5). The World Evangelical Alliance Mission Commission, 6). Momentum, Unreached Peoples, 7). The Global Network of Mission Structures, 8). Network of Church Structures, 9) Edinburgh 1910: Transform World Connections in Singapore, 10). International Association of Mission scholars (IAMS)

for Christian mission in the 21st century. With the hindsight afforded into the global conferences of the last century servants of the body of Christ have the opportunity to wisely consider that which will honor God and advance His purposes as global mission events are planned and sponsored at the beginning of this century.

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APPENDIX A
EDINBURGH 2010
Centenary of the Edinburgh 1910 World Missionary Conference

MISSION IN HUMILITY AND HOPE

Introduction

The time to celebrate the centenary of the Edinburgh 1910 World Missionary Conference is approaching. To be true to this memory, however, there is need for much more than nostalgia. Edinburgh 2010 is the proposed hub for an international round of initiatives and events geared to find direction for Christian mission in the 21st century.

The World Missionary Conference held in Edinburgh in 1910 proved epoch making in its day, offering a first glimpse of the church as a truly global missionary community with deep roots and vibrant life on every continent. It gave rise to the International Missionary Council in 1921, subsequently to the formation of the World Council of Churches in 1948 and to their merger in 1961. It inspired both the contemporary ecumenical movement and movements for world evangelisation such as the Lausanne Committee created in 1974.

Thoughts of 2010 have been gaining momentum over the last five years and in June 2005 a small but representative group of mission leaders and thinkers gathered in Edinburgh to form concrete proposals. The centenary of the Conference in 2010 is envisioned as an occasion for challenging global missionary movements. Can we do for the 21st century what Edinburgh 1910 did for the 20th, i.e. catch a vision and set an agenda which will give direction and energy to missionary movements?

In important ways Edinburgh 2010 will be different from Edinburgh 1910.

1. Rather than being centred in Edinburgh, a polycentric approach will be taken. Facilitation will be offered by a variety of centres in different parts of the world. In 2010 it is anticipated that significant events will take place not only in Scotland but in many locations around the world.

2. Whereas 1910 was confined to mainline Protestantism, the participants in 2010 will be drawn from the whole range of Christian traditions and confessions. Particular effort will be made to involve new and indigenous streams of Christian witness from different parts of the world.

3. Instead of being largely limited to the North Atlantic, there will be an intentional bias to the South, recognising that Christianity's centre of gravity has moved markedly southwards during the past century. The process will aim to be truly worldwide in its scope.

The major instrument of preparation for Edinburgh 2010 is a round of commissions; an echo of the 8 commissions which reported to the 1910 Conference. The subject matter of the commissions has been carefully chosen to engage with the great challenges facing church and mission in the 21st century.

Each commission will be hosted by a suitably equipped centre which will be responsible to build a network of mission thinkers and practitioners who have expertise and experience to bring to the particular topic in view. The host centres will be located in a variety of contexts worldwide but each will aim to engage a fully international network of participation.

Three important adjuncts to the commissions have been proposed.

1. A realistic look at where we have come from by means of a penetrating – and in places painful – historical survey of Christian mission since 1910. This will aim to be comprehensive in covering global trends, regional factors and prominent issues.

2. An informative look at where we are now by the creation of an Atlas of Global Christianity. This will reflect the ground-breaking Statistical Atlas of Christian Missions prepared for the 1910 Conference and show the global spread of Christianity in the ensuing years.

3. An international art exhibition, on the theme "Who is Christ?", as an event for 2010. This will draw on Christian art worldwide and create an exhibition which will be accessible both physically and on the web.

There still exists a high degree of flexibility in planning for 2010 but the hope is to generate a unique resource for the world church through the new commissions and to feed the fruits of their efforts into one or several events assessing the challenges of a new century and hearing the missionary call of God for our changed world in 2010.

The Formation of an International Council

For such an ambitious project a coordinating body is needed: to provide leadership, to guide the planning process and ensure that the eight proposed commissions work in a consistent and coherent way. It is recommended that an International Council be formed to serve for the five-year period 2006-10. It will aim to include a broad cross-section of world Christianity. Organisations hoping to be involved in marking the centenary or to participate in the common study process leading up to 2010 are invited to nominate

representatives to serve on the Council. These representatives will be empowered to share in the decision-making process of the Council, without having to refer back to their home organisations every time a decision needs to be taken. Organisations will be asked to cover the costs of their representatives. The centres hosting the commissions will also be represented on the International Council. It is recommended that the Council should be formed on 1 January 2006.

It was agreed by the International Consultation held in June 2005 that its members (listed below) would form an Interim International Council with responsibility for leading the process from June to December 2005. It was further agreed that the Towards 2010 Scottish Council coordinate the work during this period.

The Interim International Council formed a sub-committee to prepare an organisational and financial plan for the Towards 2010 process with membership as follows: Kwame Bediako, Frans Dokman, Jacques Matthey, Fergus Macdonald, Birger Nygaard, Kenneth Ross.

The New Round of Commissions

Essential to the work of the Edinburgh 1910 Conference, and of abiding value, were the findings of the eight think-tanks or 'commissions'. The new round of commissions has been warmly welcomed as a useful and appropriate preparation for the centenary. The Towards 2010 Scottish Council received many suggestions as to subject matter for the new commissions. The International Consultation reflected intensively on this in order to identify key issues for Christian mission in the 21st century and the topics listed below were identified as calling for the establishment of commissions for Edinburgh 2010.

Recognising the global character of the church today, it was agreed that the organisational base for the commissions should be a web of institutions located in different parts of the world. Each will need: high academic standards; strong links to church life and missionary outreach; and a sufficient communications infrastructure. Each commission will develop a fully international network to bring the highest qualities of reflection, insight and experience to the complex issues found at the interface between the Gospel and ever changing patterns of human belief and behaviour.

Following are the suggested titles for each commission, an outline of the subject matter and key questions to be addressed. The suggestions provided should be regarded as provisional – a starting point from which each commission will develop its particular approach. Commissions will be asked to gather, evaluate and share models and stories of good practice.

Already there is widespread enthusiasm for the project but it needs to engage a still wider circle if it is to achieve its objective of being representative of world Christianity. Your involvement and participation are invited. If you are struggling to discern God's direction

for Christian mission in the 21st century and to discover the fresh energy of the Holy Spirit for outreach in Christ's name, then this initiative is for you.

The Eight Commissions

1. Foundations for mission
2. Christian mission among other Faiths
3. Mission and postmodernities
4. Mission and power
5. Forms of missionary engagement
6. Theological education and formation
7. Christian communities in contemporary contexts
8. Mission spirituality for the Kingdom of God

1. Foundations for mission

The task of this commission will be to explore how a Trinitarian understanding of God as Father, Son and Holy Spirit relates to the theory and practice of mission; how the confession that God has a missionary identity impacts Christian witness; how a discernment of the Trinitarian God's inner relationships and love impacts ecclesiology, community life and society. The meaning of salvation will be considered in its biblical witness and in relation to freedom from every form of slavery in every context and culture. The commission will consider the interfaces between the Trinity, mission, salvation, ecclesiology and scripture.

Key issues and questions

1. The relation of the Trinitarian nature of God to our understanding of Christian mission.

2. The relation of Christology to mission theology and practice.

3. The relation of the work of the Holy Spirit to mission theology and practice.

4. How does our understanding of the mission of the Triune God affect our ecclesiology and church practice?

5. What do we mean by salvation, present and future? What is its link to conversion, baptism and participation in the sacramental life of the church?

6. How does our understanding of salvation affect the way we do mission?

7. How does mission engagement affect our biblical hermeneutics and vice-versa?

2. Christian mission among other Faiths

This commission will investigate ways of witnessing to Christ while acknowledging the religious plurality of a world experiencing a resurgence of religious belief and an escalation of conflict. It will explore the theological meaning of religious plurality reflecting on how it bears on Christian soteriology and missiology and address questions of conversion, proselytisation, dialogue and encounter. It will be invited to explore issues such as religious fundamentalism, persecution, 'secret' and 'churchless' believers and the continuing growth of many different forms of religious conviction. Studies undertaken under this commission will as much as possible be conducted together with or in consultation with representatives of other faiths.

Key issues and questions

1. Developing our theological understanding of the presence of non-Christian religions in the world.

2. The nature of the Christian proclamation to people of other Faiths and how we understand salvation in relation to those of other Faiths.
3. What is the meaning of "world evangelisation" today?

4. How do we bear witness to the uniqueness of Jesus in a multi-religious world?

5. How does a pneumatology defined within a Trinitarian framework affect our understanding of the significance of other religions and the nature of our mission?

6. How do we understand the activity of spirits, as understood within traditions in which they play a prominent role?

7. What is the significance of New Age and other religious movements for Christian mission?

8. How do we understand syncretism?

9. How does the mission activity of other Faiths affect Christian mission?

3. Mission and postmodernities

The commission will be asked to take on the issues raised by the new phenomena of postmodernity and their significance for mission. This will involve an investigation of 21st century thought structures, religious beliefs and practices as well as ethical principles in our world of information technology. It will also require consideration of the influence of post-colonialism, economic structures, internationalism and engagement (or disengagement) with institutions and particularly with institutional religion. The commission will discern commonalties and particularities in postmodern developments in different regions of the world

Key issues and questions

1. What do we mean by postmodernity/ies, and in what contexts do we see its/their influence?

2. What is the relationship between postmodernity, globalisation, and neo-colonialism?

3. How does postmodernity affect understanding of the basis of Christian faith, and hence of Christian mission; particularly in and from Europe?

4. What are the promises and potentials of postmodernity/ies for new understandings of mission?

5. What is the relationship between believing and belonging, both with regard to Christian discipleship and to the agencies of mission?

6. How do we understand and engage with postmodern patterns of community, including virtual communities on the Internet?

7. What have been the effects of postmodernity on Christian mission in Europe and in other regions? What is similar from region to region? How is postmodernity perceived by churches in the South? How will present and foreseeable developments affect churches and their mission in all regions? What response needs to be made?

8. How do we tell the biblical story to those who embrace postmodern relativism and are suspicious of all metanarratives?

4. Mission and power

The commission will recognise that mission is practised in a world shaped by various forms of power: spiritual, political, military, financial and international; raising issues of culture change, human rights, ecological sustainability and inequalities in the production, distribution and consumption of resources. It will consider tensions and asymmetries resulting from the exercise of power and how these affect the sharing and communication of the Gospel message and life. It will assess the function of both power and weakness in our understanding and practice of Christian mission.

Key issues and questions

1. Power within the church; power between churches; power between mission bodies and churches. Can mission be a form of manipulation? What strategies are needed to guard against exploitation?
2. Power between church and state: in the different contexts in which we find ourselves how can Christians ensure that their relationship to the state does not compromise loyalty to their faith? Is state protection for missionaries justifiable?
3. Idolatry of the market: how does the 'idolatry' of the modern market economy affect Christian faith and mission?
4. Internalisation of power structures: how can we guard against unexamined presuppositions, blinkered thinking, cultural conditioning and adverse spiritual powers? How can we be remade in God's image?
5. Reconstruction of power: can political reconstruction foster democratic processes? How does structural and political violence affect the witness of the Gospel?
6. Creative power: is there a positive and creative use of power in mission? How can missions avoid being subverted by the human will to power? What is the role of vulnerability in mission?
7. Indigenous peoples: how can we proclaim the Gospel without destroying indigenous cultures?

5. Forms of missionary engagement

The commission is invited to recognise and consider the huge variety of groups, organisations, trends, methods and new expressions of church life involved in mission today. It will seek to discern where initiative lies in today's missionary movements. It will be forward looking in assessing patterns, initiatives and developments as they emerge and considering their implications for the future. It will treat issues of mission strategy, diversity and cooperation and identify problems of conflict and misuse of resources.

Key issues and questions

1. The primary role of the local church in mission: what does it take for the local church to become the primary missional agent through the priesthood of all believers? How is the local church related to the universal responsibility of Christian mission?
2. What forms of cooperation are appropriate to mission today? How may reciprocal partnerships best be developed?
3. What forms does "mission in poverty" / "mission without power" take?
4. In what ways can those in centres of power receive the gift of the Gospel from missionaries who come from the disempowered peripheries?
5. What are the implications of recent developments in cross-cultural mission: South-South, South-North? What is the future and role of the Western missionary movement? What is the future and role of the missionary movement in and from the South?
6. The role of media in evangelization.
7. How do we formulate mission strategy that is biblically based, theologically informed and ecclesiologically responsible, yet concrete and operational?

6. Theological education and formation

The commission is to examine the connection between the catechetical and missional mandates of the church. It will consider how to strengthen the missional aspects of the training and formation of every member of the church, as well as the ordained and lay leaders. Included in the study will be educational methodologies, theological study, character development, spiritual formation and the contemporary context. The commission will further examine the relation between academy and society, clergy and laity, local and global issues, resources, relevance and gifts.

Key issues and questions

1. How can every member of the people of God be motivated and empowered for mission?
2. How can formation of mission spirituality become integrated into theological training programs?
3. How can the study of missiology become an integral part of the theological curriculum? How can mission perspectives be integrated into every theological discipline?

4. The role of accreditation in relation to mission and ministry.
5. How can churches best develop relevant curricula for local contexts?
6. Specific training for cross-cultural ministries and for those involved in reconciliation ministry.
7. Catalysts for theological training and formation where theological institutions are lacking.

7. Christian communities in contemporary contexts

This commission will focus on the variety of Christian communities as they draw on different traditions and engage with specific contexts. It will take cognisance of such issues as urbanisation, immigrant communities, migrant workers, affluence, poverty and virtual worlds. It will note underlying forms of Christian expression including such concepts as world view, language, customs, traditions, inculturation, transformation, etc. It will examine ways in which churches can become holistic healing and reconciling communities, expressing both the welcoming and the transforming character of Christ's gospel. It will explore what is involved in deep-level conversion.

Key issues and questions

1. How do adjectives of Christian community such as *discipling, healing, witnessing, contextual* become lived realities in today's world?
2. What is involved in being the church in the cities and mega-cities of today?
3. How can the local church be an agent of the kingdom of God and a source of healing and reconciliation?
4. What is the true identity (the "core DNA") of the church? How does it manifest itself in different denominations and cultures?
5. Ethnicity – the tension between homogenous and multi-ethnic churches.
6. Church life in Diaspora communities.
7. HIV/AIDS – does Christian mission bear some responsibility for the spread of the virus? How can mission contribute to the struggle to stop the pandemic?
8. What other forms of ill-health call for particular attention from practitioners of Christian mission?

8. Mission spirituality for the Kingdom of God

The commission on mission spirituality will seek to articulate a motivation and dynamic for mission that is rooted in the Kingdom of God. It will draw on the experience of the early church, of Christians from all ages, as well as that of new Christian movements, and of the many new churches in the South. It will seek to understand mission in relation to such concepts as new creation, spiritual gifts, renewal, reconstruction, identity, service and holism. It will explore the role of the Spirit and of the church as signs and portents of the goal of all endeavour in the glory of God.

Key issues and questions

1. What shape does Christian mission take when it has the Kingdom of God as its ultimate horizon?

2. What is the proper place of the natural order in mission spirituality?

3. Prophetic witness: challenging the "principalities and powers" of human institutions with "signs and wonders" and God-given spiritual authority.

4. Love of enemies; reconciliation and healing through the power of the Cross, and witness through self-emptying, humility, and sacrifice.

5. How can we form new and creative relationships with Christians of all traditions, given our diverse understandings of mission, both locally and at international level? How can we form new and creative relationships with fellow human beings beyond the church?

6. How can we be faithful to our Christian confession while being open, adventurous and discerning in encounter with representatives of other religions?

Institutions presently considering hosting commissions are:

Akrofi-Christaller Centre, Akropong-Akuapem, Ghana
Centre for the Study of Christianity in Asia, Trinity Theological College, Singapore
Chicago Center for Global Ministries
ISEDET, Ecumenical Centre for Higher Education, Buenos Aires
Nordic Institute for Mission and Ecumenical Research
Southern African Missiological Society
United Theological College, Bangalore

At this stage this is a provisional and by no means final or exclusive list.

Coordinating hosts are to be selected on the basis of:

1. Geographic and denominational diversity.
2. Academic excellence.
3. Engagement with the church and its grassroots.
4. Connection with mission practitioners.
5. Sufficient communications infra-structure.
6. Research interests and resources in the given area of study.
7. Financial commitment – together with network resources.

It is envisaged that the centres selected will work as part of a network of institutions in their particular context. From this local base they will be responsible to coordinate a worldwide network of prayerful study in their particular area of responsibility.

In order to allow the participation of a broad constituency, it was agreed that there would be a need to ensure the effective participation of Orthodox, Pentecostal and Roman Catholic institutions.

It is hoped that the commission centres will be appointed by mid 2006.

Transversal themes

It was recognised that a number of "transversals" will need to be developed, i.e. important themes which will run like a thread across all eight commissions. Some of these, e.g. Women and mission, call for a specially constituted group to ensure that they take effect. Transversals will include:

- Women and mission
- Reconciliation and healing
- Contextualization
- Authentic Discipleship
- Subaltern Voices

The kind of critical analysis which would be offered by each transversal is exemplified by the following proposal in regard to Women and mission:

Women and mission

Women and mission is envisaged not as a commission but as a separate group that will observe the process of each of the commissions with the brief of (a) ensuring that women's perspectives and issues are properly represented (b) effecting coordination among the commissions on these issues and (c) dealing with issues of Women and mission that do not find place elsewhere.

Key issues and questions

1. What is Good News for women?
2. Power used against women.
3. Women's power.
4. Machismo.
5. Eco-feminism.
6. Agents of mission.
7. Theological education, ordination and feminist theology.
8. Women's spirituality.

The associated project on the history of the 20th century missionary movement will give full consideration to the contributions that women have made to mission.

Participants at the June International Consultation

Co-Chair
Philomena Mwaura, International Association for Mission Studies
Lalsangkima Pachuau, United Theological College, Bangalore, India

Kwame Bediako, Akrofi-Kristaller Centre, Akropong-Akuapem, Ghana
Steve Bevans, Catholic Theological Union, Chicago
Nico Botha, Southern African Missiological Association
Ruth Bottoms, World Council of Churches Commission on World Mission and Evangelism

Frans Dokman, International Association for Mission Studies
Rose Dowsett, Global Missiology Track, Mission Commission, World Evangelical Alliance
Tormod Engelsviken, World Council of Churches Commission on World Mission and Evangelism
Kofi deGraft-Johnson, Church Mission Society, Anglican Communion
Michiko Kyoko Ete-Lima, Council for World Mission
Sebastian Kim, College of York St John, University of Leeds
Moonjang Lee, Centre for the Study of Christianity in Asia, Trinity Theological College, Singapore
Carlos Rodriguez Linera, SEDOS, Service of Documentation and Studies on Mission, Rome
Wonsuk Ma, Asia Pacific Theological Seminary, Philippines
Fergus MacDonald, Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization
Jacques Matthey, World Council of Churches Commission on World Mission and Evangelism
Nestor Miguez, ISEDET, Buenos Aires
Birger Nygaard, Areopagus Foundation, Denmark
Miguel Palomino, Latin America Graduate School of Theology

Secretariat
David Kerr, University of Lund
David Miller, International Christian College, Glasgow
Kenneth Ross, Church of Scotland
Jack Thompson, University of Edinburgh

Participation and Prayer

Prayer for this process is the primary form of participation that is needed and invited. Since it is an initiative which is seeking to engage with today's realities at a spiritual level it will only be as strong as its life of prayer.

The hope of the Interim International Council is that the process will become as widely participative as possible. Therefore if you, your organisation or institution are interested in being informed about Edinburgh 2010 or if you would like to apply to participate in the preparations for the event/s then please complete and return the form below.

Please tick the relevant boxes and return to: Towards 2010, World Mission, 121, George Street, Edinburgh, EH2 4YN, UK. kross@world-mission.org	
• I wish to be kept up to date with developments as they happen.	
• I wish the organisation of which I am part to be represented on the International Council.	
• I wish to receive further information about commission no.….	

Name
Organisation/institution
Address
E mail address